

TLS 2026 Schedule

Friday	
9:00 AM - 9:15 AM (15min)	Opening Remarks
9:15 AM - 11:15 AM (2hrs)	Talks 9:15 AM Language processing demands predict biological brain age: MRI evidence from bilinguals, translators, and interpreters <i>Mingshi Chen, Michal Korenar, Anoek Schrantee, Henk Marquering, Matthan W. A. Caan, Liesbeth Reneman</i> 9:45 AM From Observers to Interpreters: Role-Conditioned Semantic Development in Bimodal Bilingual CODA Children <i>Meghan Bond</i> 10:15 AM Unequal Granularity: The Lexicographical Treatment of Basque, Occitan, and Sicilian Borrowings in Spanish (VIRTUAL) <i>Gonzalo Maestro Paredes</i> 10:45 AM Continuous measures of bilingualism predict memory generalization in early childhood <i>Xiaoqiao Wang, Stephanie Castro, Sarah Irene Muller, Maria M. Arredondo</i>
11:15 AM - 12:30 PM (1hr 15 min)	Keynote Speech (Dr. Deborah Chen Pichler) The overlooked sign language learners: Hearing parents of deaf children Abstract: A dramatic rise in hearing sign language learners has fuelled a surge of research on L2 sign language acquisition over the last 20 years, uncovering acquisition patterns that are potentially unique to L2 learning in a new modality. Within two short decades, this new subfield of M2L2 acquisition, or acquisition of an L2 in a different modality than one's previous language(s), has expanded to encompass learner patterns for dozens of national sign languages. This flurry of sign language acquisition research focuses mainly on classroom learners, however, and overlooks an important sub-group of L2 learners:

	hearing parents learning to sign with their deaf and hard of hearing (DHH) children. As hearing adults learning their first sign language, hearing parents might be expected to resemble their high school- and college-aged counterparts in many respects. Yet I argue that the two groups differ fundamentally in their motivation, context and resources for sign language learning, such that hearing parents warrant dedicated investigation as a distinct population of L2 signers. They also warrant urgent investigation: the stakes for hearing parents' sign language learning are exceptionally high, given the key role they play in their DHH child's early language development, but they receive relatively little societal support, and may even face active opposition to their decision to use a sign language. In this presentation, I first summarize the small linguistics literature on L2 sign language acquisition by hearing parent signers, pointing out the many areas that are still under-investigated. I then introduce the Family ASL project, which tracks hearing parents and their DHH children as they learn American Sign Language (ASL) together in a family context. Now in its 7th year, the Family ASL project has yielded unprecedented detail on the L2 development of hearing parents' ASL and the ways in which they incorporate signing into their DHH child's daily life. I will also share insights from hearing parents about the challenges of establishing ASL as a viable family language, often alongside spoken English, and touch on the ideological debate that surrounds hearing families that sign. Talk: 45 min Q&A: 30 min
12:30 PM - 1:15 PM (45 min)	Lunch Break
1:15 PM - 2:30 PM (1hr 15min)	Poster session From Evidential to Stance Marker: Discourse-Functional Extensions of Korean -tela and -telako <i>Junghye Baik</i> From Children to Mice to Apples? Tracking the Boundaries of Plural and Collective Marker "Men" in Spoken Mandarin <i>Pu Meng</i>

	Negotiating Du Coup: Language Ideologies in Digital and Traditional Media <i>Ashton Carter</i> Connections in the Mental Lexicon: How Language Experience and Lexical Properties Influence Word Associations <i>Matias Fernandez-Duque, Viorica Marian</i> Role Exhaustion and Unique Path Constraint in the complex predication logic of multiply iterated resultatives and low depictives <i>Abdel-Rahman Abu Helal</i> Examining articulatory competition using phonetic measures of tongue twisters. <i>Joelle Fahoum, Sarah Irons</i> Periphrastic causative constructions with machen in Texas German <i>Utpal Pandey, Lena Braun</i> Bare vs. Anaphoric Definites in Yorùbá. <i>Blessing Abiodun</i> Word-Referent Mapping in Bilingual Toddlers and the Role of Sociocultural Influences <i>Stephanie Castro, Maria M. Arredondo</i> What we want to do is (to) glimpse how LMs learn language <i>Youn-Gyu Park</i>
2:30 PM - 2:45 PM (15min)	Break
2:45 PM - 5:15 PM (2hrs 30min)	Talks 2:45 PM Populist Discourse versus Democratic Appeals: A Corpus based analysis of the Rhetorical Strategies of Trump and Harris <i>Habibullah Pathan</i> 3:15 PM A Diachronic Approach to Impolite Expressions Using Metaphor: Focusing on Online News Article Comments <i>Daeun Kang</i>

	3:45 PM LANGUAGE AS A MEANS OF COMMUNICATING CULTURAL IDENTITY: A DISCOURSE ANALYSIS OF PRAYER OF AKWASIDAE FESTIVAL (VIRTUAL) <i>Kenneth Adarkwa Yiadom Oppong</i> 4:15 PM Code-Switching and Vernacularisation in Colonial Medical Writing: A Taiwanese Case Study <i>Tingting Christina Hsu</i> 4:45PM Mapping the Islands: A Mechanistic Analysis of the Coordinate Structure Constraint in Transformer LMs <i>Sasha Boguraev</i>
5:30 PM	Social at Tweedy's 2908 Fruth St B Unit 101, Austin, TX 78705
Saturday	
9:00 AM - 11:00 AM (2hrs)	Talks 9:00 AM Integrating Multiple Types of Statistical Regularities to Accelerate Novel Word Learning <i>Melina Knabe, Chen Yu</i> 9:30 AM Tracking early syntactic development in the expressive language of late talkers: A longitudinal study with syntactic dependency network analysis (VIRTUAL) <i>Xiaohui Bai</i> 10:00 AM How do parents allocate attention between their child and the objects they talk about after labeling? <i>Fateme Mohseni, Chen Yu, Zenzi M Griffin</i> 10:30 AM "I have enough English": A Long-Term Perspective on

	Acculturation and Second Language Acquisition <i>Sara Maria Gace</i>
11:00 AM - 11:15 AM (15min)	Break (15min)
11:15 AM - 12:30 PM (1hr 15min)	Keynote Speech (Dr. Rachel Dudley) How children discover the difference between know and think Abstract: Linguistic input is not directly intended to support language acquisition, but instead comes from ordinary conversations where speakers try to achieve practical goals. Despite this, children make rapid progress with word learning, managing to strip away layers of contextual information to discern subtle semantic distinctions. This talk examines how children discover the factivity contrast between know and think: know can only be fairly used when the speaker takes for granted the truth of the complement, while think has no such restriction. When do children discover this contrast? And more importantly how do they do so? I'll present a line of work suggesting that the input does not directly reveal this factivity contrast, and furthermore that children may infer the distinction from indirect but correlated cues in the syntactic distributions of the two verbs & in the range of discourse moves that speakers use them to achieve. This more indirect pathway to the contrast is supported by principled connections across the interfaces, providing insight into the constraints on meaning that may guide language acquisition. Talk: 45 min Q&A: 30 min
12:30 PM - 1:15 PM (45min)	Lunch Break
1:15 PM - 2:30 PM (1hr 15min)	Keynote Speech (Dr. Kanishka Misra) Hypothesis Generation as a Bridge between Human and Machine Cognitive Science Abstract: The success of LMs in demonstrating non-trivially interesting linguistic behavior has raised a lot of excitement about the transfer of insights to (human) language science. But in order for this excitement to materialize, appropriate bridges

	need to be built from studies on computational models (Machine Cognitive Science) and those in humans (Human Cognitive Science). In this talk, I will discuss one possible bridge between the two systems: the development of hypothesis generation methods from which we can obtain novel predictions about human language that are sufficiently specific to be tested in the lab. I will present a case study where we used LMs trained on child-directed speech to generate novel hypotheses about the generalization of a novel dative verb to the alternate construction, given exposure to only one dative construction. That is, if the novel verb 'pilked' is observed in the double-object (She pilked me the ball), then under what conditions is it also found acceptable in the prepositional-object (He pilked a book to her)? Our method yields two new experiments that follow from our generated hypotheses, which we propose to test with human learners in the lab. Talk: 45 min Q&A: 30 min
2:30 PM - 2:45 PM (15min)	Break (15min)
2:45 PM - 4:45 PM (2hrs)	Talks 2:45 PM Emergence of Filler–Gap Mechanisms in Developmentally Constrained Language Models (VIRTUAL) <i>Atrey Desai, Sathvik Nair</i> 3:15 PM The Evolution of Informality in Applied Linguistics Academic Writing <i>Babatope Stephen Falohun</i> 3:45 PM Plurality, pluractionality, and “half-plurality” in Iñapari (Arawakan) <i>Barrett Hamp</i> 4:15 PM Language Contact Between Modalities: Egyptian Sign Language and Arabic <i>Ethan Hartzell</i>

4:45 PM - 5:00 PM (15min)	Closing Remarks
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